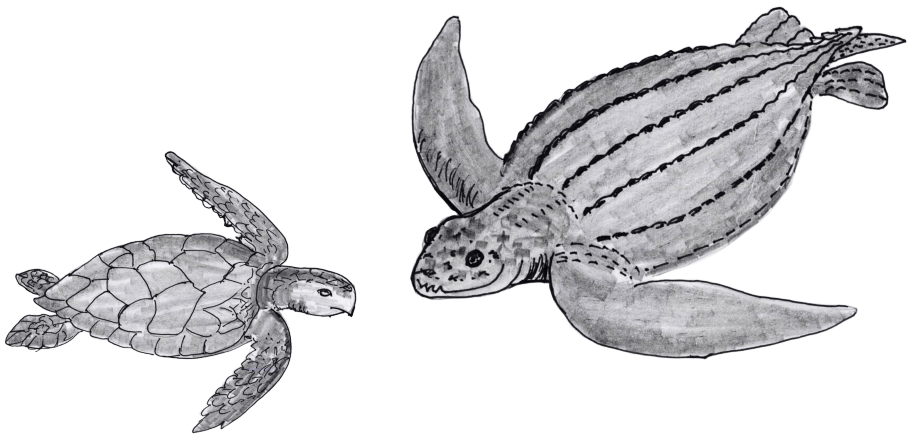
Chapter 26

A goroto – The turtle

Naphtali Maion & Ondria Tavagaga



(a) (b)

Figure 1: (a) *Unava* – A small kind of turtle, (b) *Toorue* – The largest kind of Turtle

(1)	***Goroto***	**Turtle**
(2)	*A goroto a iana a beera sana.*	The turtle is a very big swimming animal.
(3)	*Bean tara e, ean repaa tara voen:*	When you see it, you see:

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(4)	*A goroto na tei me nana bono kahoo, o dorana o pakapaka,*	The turtle has a head and four flippers.
(5)	*O kapa vaa toonunae o kikis, o kapa vaa domonae saka kikis haana.*	The shell on its back is hard, the shell on its chest is not hard.
(6)	*Teo dorana o pakapaka, o buaku vaa kahoo nae na dao raara bono huahua.*	As for the four flippers, the two flippers near its head we call the paddles.
(7)	*A goroto na huahua vakikis ni nana bono buo pakapaka bona.*	The turtle strongly paddles with these two flippers.
(8)	*O buo pakapaka vaa murinae to vakarovo bata ni nae bara na hua ni nae mee.*	The two hind flippers it uses for steering and also for paddling.
(9)	*A goroto na vaavuriha nana mee be tavusu kahi bona tahii, ore paa ruuvu gunaha vahaa.*	The turtle also breathes when it comes out of the water, then it dives down again.
(10)	*A goroto vai a moon be tau vahuhu, ore paa gunaha vo teo kakaamuru.*	When the female turtle is about to lay eggs, it goes ashore to the white sand.
(11)	*Na kasi nana bona govee kasuana*	It digs a hole in the ground,
(12)	*ore paa vahuhu komana govee*	then it lays its eggs into the hole
(13)	*ore paa pae vahaa bona.*	and fills the hole up again.
(14)	*Evehee bea goroto pae vahaa bona govee, na varovarova nae,*	But when the turtle fills up the hole again, it becomes invisable,
(15)	*a aba ore saka antee haa bona tea vurahe vakahu.*	so that a human being cannot quickly find it.
(16)	*A rupi a bero kurusu to vahuhu nana a goroto.*	The turtle lays many eggs indeed.
(17)	*Toro oha nana bono taonim saavun.*	It must be more than fifty.
(18)	*Bea peha aba naonao tea ruuvu goroto, na nao vatotobin vo nana irihi.*	When someone goes diving for turtles, he goes straight to the edge of the reef.
(19)	*O goroto na teitei rori irihi tea maa avaava vasu ei teo hum namana.*	The turtles stay at the edge of the reef in the caves of the rocks at the side of the ocean.
(20)	*Bea tahii masi, ore paa vurahe vakahu koa bono goroto*	When the sea is at low tide (so that the reef is visable), then he can quickly find the turtles,

(21) *beori ani rori bono vasukare bara tea maa avaava vasu ae tea maa vaagoroto.*
when they are eating the *vasukare* corals and are in the rock caves and in the turtle tunnels.

(22) ***Havee to gono kaakoo mi riori bona goroto***
How they catch a turtle

(23) *A goroto na ato riori tea kave,*
They get hold of the turtle with the net,

(24) *ei beori nao tea veo goroto.*
this means when they go turtle netting.

(25) *A kave bona a beera sana.*
This net is very big.

(26) *Na antee nana tea kana bono buaku saavun goroto.*
It can catch twenty turtles.

(27) *Amaa peha maa vuri to naonao riori tea ruuvu goroto.*
Sometimes they go diving for turtles.

(28) *A goroto mee na kapa riori bea goroto gunaha nao tea vahuhu kasuana.*
They also catch a turtle when the turtle goes ashore to lay its eggs in the sand.

(29) *Tea maa vuri sunuu, a goroto mee na vurahe riori ei be masi pina ni tea maa kopua.*
When they go fishing with torches, they also find the turtle when it gets trapped in the lagoons at low tide.

(30) ***Havee to kaku goroto vaavaha vo ria abana vaa Teapu***
How turtles are butchered by the Teop people

(31) *Nabunuu roho, a kaku goroto, amaa abana bebeera koa to pakupaku roho bari.*
In former times the butchering of turtles was only done by the big men.

(32) *Ean saka antee haa nom tea tara ta peha beiko ge ta peha visoasi teo hum vai to kaku goroto riori.*
You could not see any child or any young man at the place where they were butchering turtles.

(33) *A kiu tea abana bebeera koa, paku vonae tea kaku guu mee.*
It was exclusively the work of the chiefs, it was like butchering pigs.

(34) *Nomana amaa matapaku vai paa rova kahi avuaraara.*
Today these practices have disappeared from us.

(35)	*Nomana bean tau kaku a goroto – paku koai; ahiki vira to moroko nae vahaa.*	Today, when you are about to butcher a turtle – just do it; indeed, there is not any talk about it.
(36)	***Amaa hanana vaa tea kaku goroto:***	**The ways of butchering turtles:**
(37)	*Rahi gunaha a goroto teo hum to kahi kaku noman e.*	Pull the turtle ashore to the place where you are going to butcher it.
(38)	*Garuhu vira nio kasuana.*	Thoroughly wash the sand off.
(39)	*Navuhu vamate a goroto, navuhu kii gogoonae.*	Hit the turtle dead, hit it on its throat.
(40)	*Pee o kapa vaa domonae, pee murina koa o vavaarihi.*	Cut the shell on its chest, subsequently cut the sides.
(41)	*Ean repaa kapae.*	Then you take its shell off.
(42)	*Rake nao o pusu no hiapa to taneo maana teo orooromo,*	Search for the upper end of the intestines that begin in its throat,
(43)	*pee kurukurusui, rahi tavusu kahi bona komana goroto.*	cut them off, pull them out of the belly of the turtle.
(44)	*Rahi tavusu vakavara o hiapa ae amaa meha taba vaa tea goroto,*	When you have completely pulled out the instestines and the other things in the turtle,
(45)	*kana tavusu o revasin.*	scoop the blood out.
(46)	*Peepee vihu amaa pakapaka nae (o dorana) bara o kahoo.*	Cut off its flippers (the four) and the head.
(47)	*Vaanoto o suraa o beera mene rava bona mata goroto.*	Light a big fire for heating the pieces of the turtle.
(48)	*Rava vakavara, vaatei a mata goroto teo bana.*	After having heated them up, put the turtle pieces on a mat.
(49)	*Vaagunagunaha a mata goroto, ean repaa peepee vaantee a peepeha mono goroto.*	Cut the turtle pieces further up, then you cut enough for each turtle parcel.
(50)	*Monomono a goroto. Kavara vai voen, vaatei vai tea tao.*	Wrap the turtle up into parcels. When it's finished in this way, put (the parcels) into the earth oven.
(51)	*Amaa hum vaa komana goroto na aniani ria ta Teapu.*	The parts inside the turtle are eaten by the Teop people

(52)	*O hiapa na peepee vakakato riori*	The intestines are cut into short pieces,
(53)	*ore paa siri kopaa bari,*	then they are torn into strips,
(54)	*ore paa garuhu vamataa bari,*	then properly washed
(55)	*ore paa vaatei bari tea nahu.*	and put into a pot.
(56)	*O gonogonono mee na peepee riori, ore paa vaatei bari tea nahu.*	The lungs are also cut up and put into a pot.
(57)	*Amaa hum vai mee, a koburu, o ganusu ae amaa meha hum.*	Also the following parts, the heart, cartilages, and the other parts
(58)	*Be kavara, ore paa vaahio bona nahu teo suraa.*	When it is finished, the pot is set on the fire.
(59)	*Na nahunahu mi riori bono hiihii ore nin mataa.*	It is cooked with ginger so that it tastes good.